PRIMEROS ALIMENTOS

HOW TO START SOLID FOODS

A short guide for the first months.

1 · WHEN TO START

AROUND 6 MONTHS

It's recommended to start around 6 months, and never before 4. More than the exact date, look at whether they're ready.

The signs they're ready

- They sit with little support and hold their head steady.
- They're interested in what you eat: they watch, open their mouth, try to grab it.
- They pick things up and bring them to their mouth.
- They no longer push food out with their tongue.

Milk is still the main thing

Until their first birthday, breast milk or formula is still their main food, on demand. Food *complements* it, it doesn't replace it: at first they eat very little, and that's normal.

And water

From the moment they start eating, offer water in a cup with meals. No pressure: they decide how much to drink.

2 · WHAT TO OFFER

IRON FIRST

There is no set order of foods. What does matter is having iron and zinc every day from the start, because their stores drop from 6 months.



In almost every meal

Meat, fish, egg or pulses, well cooked. And around them, vegetables, fruit and grains, ideally wholegrain.

Allergens: early and in small amounts

Delaying them past 6 months doesn't prevent allergy. The usual ones: egg, fish, peanut and tree nuts (as butter or finely ground), dairy and gluten. Offer them one at a time, a few days in a row and in small amounts, ideally on weekdays so you can keep an eye on them.

Mild reaction

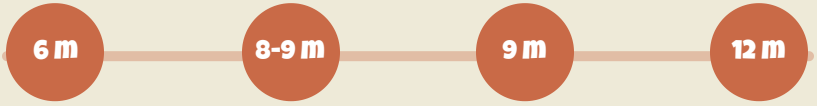
- Hives, itching or redness
- An isolated vomit
- Don't offer it again: note it down and ask your paediatrician

Severe: call emergency services

- Swollen lips, tongue or face
- Difficulty breathing
- Repeated vomiting or very floppy

3 · TEXTURES AND METHOD

From purée to pieces



6 m	8-9 m	9 m	12 m
Thick purée or soft pieces	Lumps and strips	Pincer grasp: small pieces	Like the family

Lumps as early as possible, never later than 8 or 9 months. Delaying them is linked to more feeding problems and eating less fruit and veg.

The easy test

If you can squash it between your thumb and finger, or with your tongue against the roof of your mouth, the texture is right. Strips the size of a finger (5-6 cm), so they can grab them with their fist.

Purée and spoon

Purée that gets lumpier over time. You feed them.

BLW

Soft pieces. They pick them up and decide how much to eat.

Mixed

Some purée at some meals and pieces at others.

No baby-led, responsive method is better than another. BLW isn't recommended if there are neurological or motor difficulties, or if they're not gaining weight: talk to your paediatrician first.

GAGGING OR CHOKING

Always **sitting upright**, with an adult beside them and no screens. Never reclined, in a bouncer or in the pram.

Gagging: normal

- Coughing and making noise
- Watery eyes
- Pushing the food forward
- Stay calm: don't put your fingers in or pat their back

Choking

- No coughing, crying or breathing
- Turning blue
- High-pitched noise or silence
- Act now

If they choke

1. **Call emergency services**
   or ask someone to call.
2. **5 back blows**
   face down along your forearm, head lower than chest.
3. **5 chest thrusts**
   face up, with two fingers.
4. **Repeat**
   until it comes out. If they lose consciousness, start CPR.

A paediatric first aid course is useful whatever the method, and gives real peace of mind.

5 · WHAT TO AVOID

And until when

Salt
Never add it. Their kidneys can't handle it well yet.

Sugar and juices
They promote tooth decay and a sweet tooth. Whole fruit is better.

Honey
Never before 12 months: it can carry botulism spores.

Cow's milk as a drink
Not before 12 months. Little iron and too much protein for their kidneys.

Whole nuts
Until age 5, only as nut butter or very finely ground.

Whole grapes and cherry tomatoes
Always quartered lengthways. Same with blueberries.

Large fish
High in mercury: swordfish, shark, bluefin tuna and pike.

Spinach, chard, beetroot, rocket and celery
High in nitrates. None before 12 months; from 1 to 3 years, one portion a day at most. Borage, none before age 3.

Rice drink
It builds up arsenic: best avoided. Rice and rice cakes, now and then.

All of this, unless your paediatrician says otherwise.

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AND FOR EVERY DAY, THE APP

Log what they've tried, get the day's and the week's menu, and keep all this information at hand.



Coming very soon on iPhone, Android and web.

A general guide based on the recommendations of the Spanish Association of Paediatrics (AEP). It doesn't replace your paediatrician's advice.